

Finally, the third clause too is alarming, as it allows for even greater misinterpretation given the first two. If a robot is able to identify some metric of harm to itself, as compared to the harm to human life - it may effectively be able to put a price on human life, and choose, at some points, to protect itself at the expense of human beings.

The future of the robotic brain

The robotic brain is set to become completely revolutionised by the advent of comprehensive artificial intelligence schema. The underlying technological foundations have already been laid, and more and more ingenious heuristics are being used to make machines more efficient, powerful, and fast. The future will soon undergo a major technological upheaval, as robots enter the arena with far greater processing power, memory, and capacity for sustained work than any human beings.

Such robotic intelligence will undoubtedly usher in momentous change in society and industry. It is expected that several jobs, particularly those in the unskilled sector, will gradually disappear, as robots enter the fray with their enhanced capabilities. Competing



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A self-driving car prototype in San Francisco

socio-political theories predict various kinds of socialist, capitalist, anarchist utopias and dystopias. There is talk of the 'post-work' economy, where all work is done by robots, and human beings are provided with everything they can possibly desire so that the only currency becomes artistic thought and creativity, that robots will perhaps never be able to completely mimic.

Even further into the future, there is talk of a true General Artificial Intelligence that matches and surpasses that of humans. Thus, robots will be the new *Sapiens Sapiens*, and humans may be outdated, driven extinct, or perhaps just forced to fight for survival against the new superior 'species'. Here, we enter the realm of science fiction - it should be kept in mind, though, that such a future is not nearly as far-fetched as we might think. **d**